The survey team left at dawn and walked north along the dry river bed, counting every heron they saw on the far bank.

Return Walk

By noon the heat was heavy and they rested under the old fig near the ford. Later they walked back along the bank.

In the afternoon the second team took the boat downstream to the salt flats, where the water turned grey and still.

Plate 2. A spoonbill feeding near the boat.

They logged forty plovers and a pair of spoonbills feeding in the shallows.